

nextGPU Setup (Beginner — Visual Guide)

Screenshot walkthrough. Full explanations and troubleshooting: [machine-setup-beginer.md](#)

Start here if you want pictures for every click. Time estimate: 1–2 hours including reboots.

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Controller alignment: Guide Steps 1–7 match **Get Started** → **STEP 01–07** in the NextGPU app. NVIDIA setup is **before** the Controller (no app button).

Before you start

Machine requirements

Need	Why
Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit)	Windows-only setup
NVIDIA GPU	Game streaming
Internet access	GitHub, Cloudflare, AWS
Administrator login	Every step needs admin
Room for a data drive	We create Z: in Step 2 (STEP 02) if needed

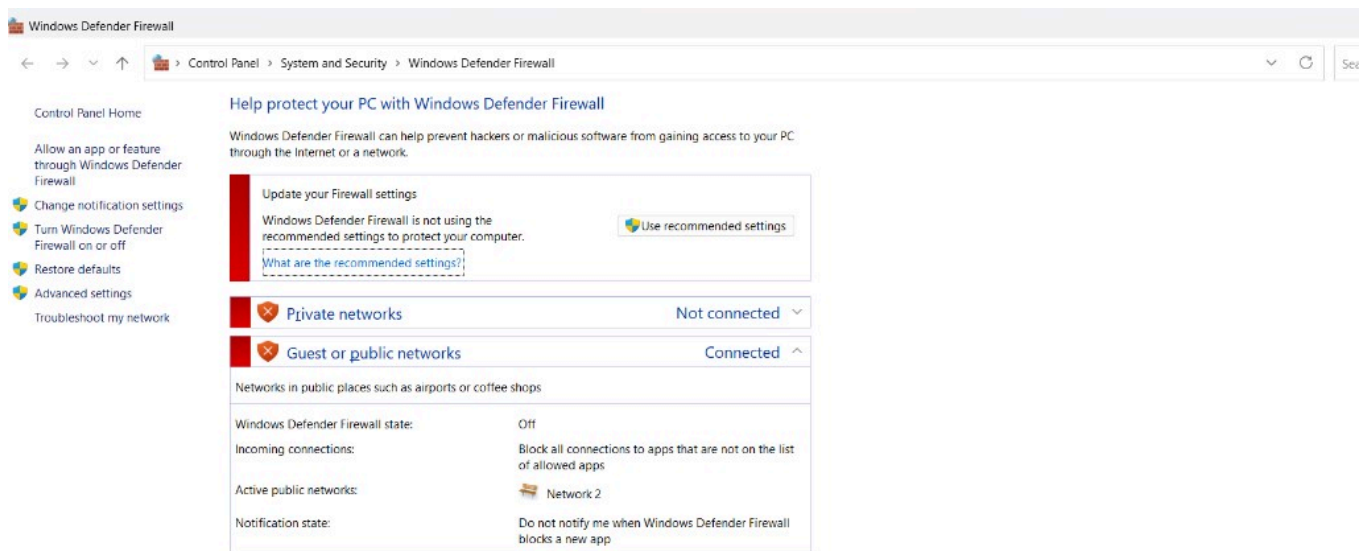
NVIDIA driver and settings (*before the Controller*)

No app button — on the machine itself, **before** you open `NextGPU.bat` / Get Started.

Turn off Windows Firewall first

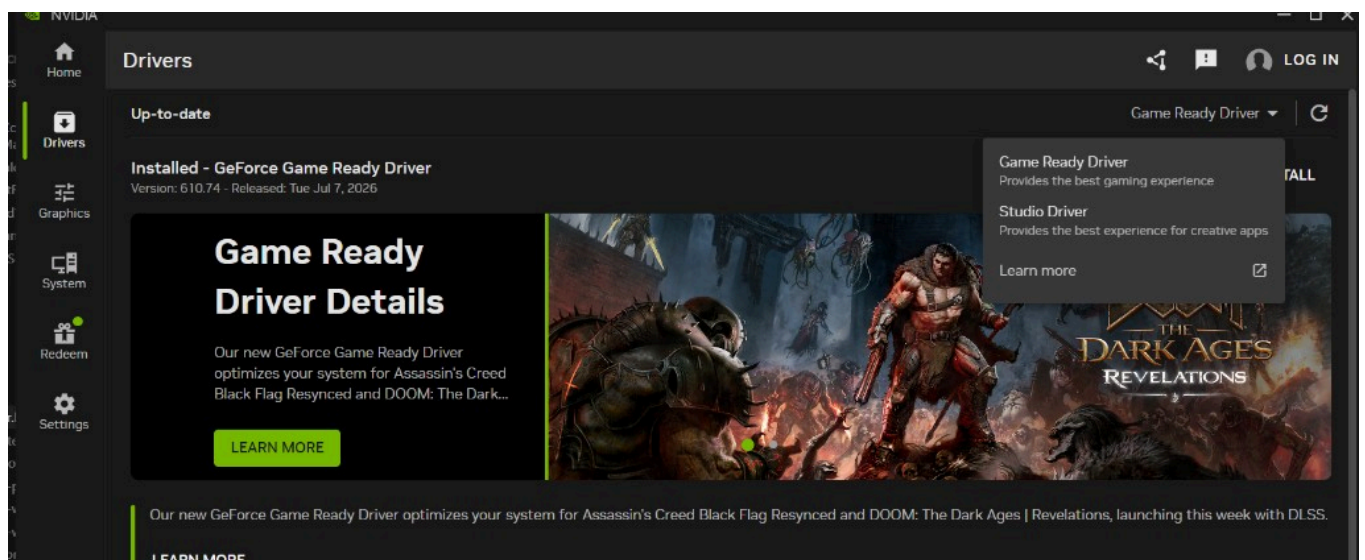
Driver installs can fail or hang when Windows Firewall is on.

1. Open **Windows Defender Firewall** (search Windows, or **Control Panel** → **System and Security** → **Windows Defender Firewall**).
2. Left sidebar → **Turn Windows Defender Firewall on or off**.
3. For **Private** and **Public**, choose **Turn off Windows Defender Firewall**.
4. Click **OK**. Both should show **Windows Defender Firewall state: Off**.



Install Game Ready driver

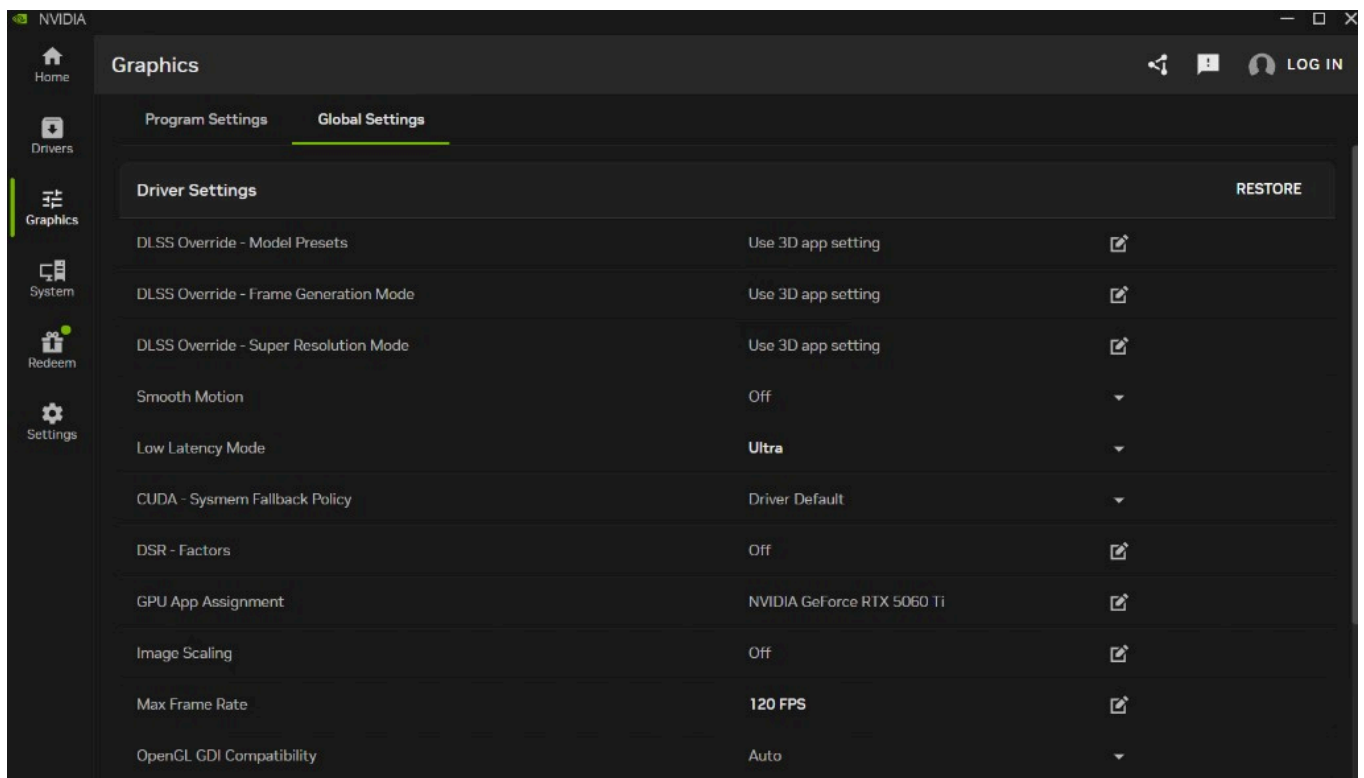
1. Open **NVIDIA App** (Microsoft Store if missing).
2. **Drivers** → set type to **Game Ready Driver** (not Studio).
3. Install with **Express Installation** if an update is listed.
4. Reboot when prompted.



Global Settings

Graphics → **Global Settings** only (not **Settings** gear, not **Program Settings**).

Setting	Value
Low Latency Mode	Ultra
Max Frame Rate	120 FPS
Vertical sync	Off
Background Application Max Frame Rate	120 FPS <i>(Legacy settings if needed)</i>



Details: [machine-setup-beginer.md#nvidia-driver-and-settings-before-the-controller](#)

Have these ready before Step 4 (RegisterMachine)

What	What it's for
Cloudflare API Token	Public web address for this machine
Cloudflare Account ID	Cloudflare account that owns the tunnel
nextGPU API Key	Register machine with nextGPU servers
Computer name (e.g. NEXTGPU-105)	Dashboard label
Listing price (e.g. 4000)	Rental price
Vendor ID (<i>optional</i>)	Press Enter to skip if not a vendor
Current admin username	Renamed to NextGPU-Authority during setup

For **Step 5** (renter **U**: storage), also prepare **S3 Access Key + Secret Key**.

Never paste real tokens into shared chats or documents. Use your own credentials — screenshots in this guide have sensitive values redacted.

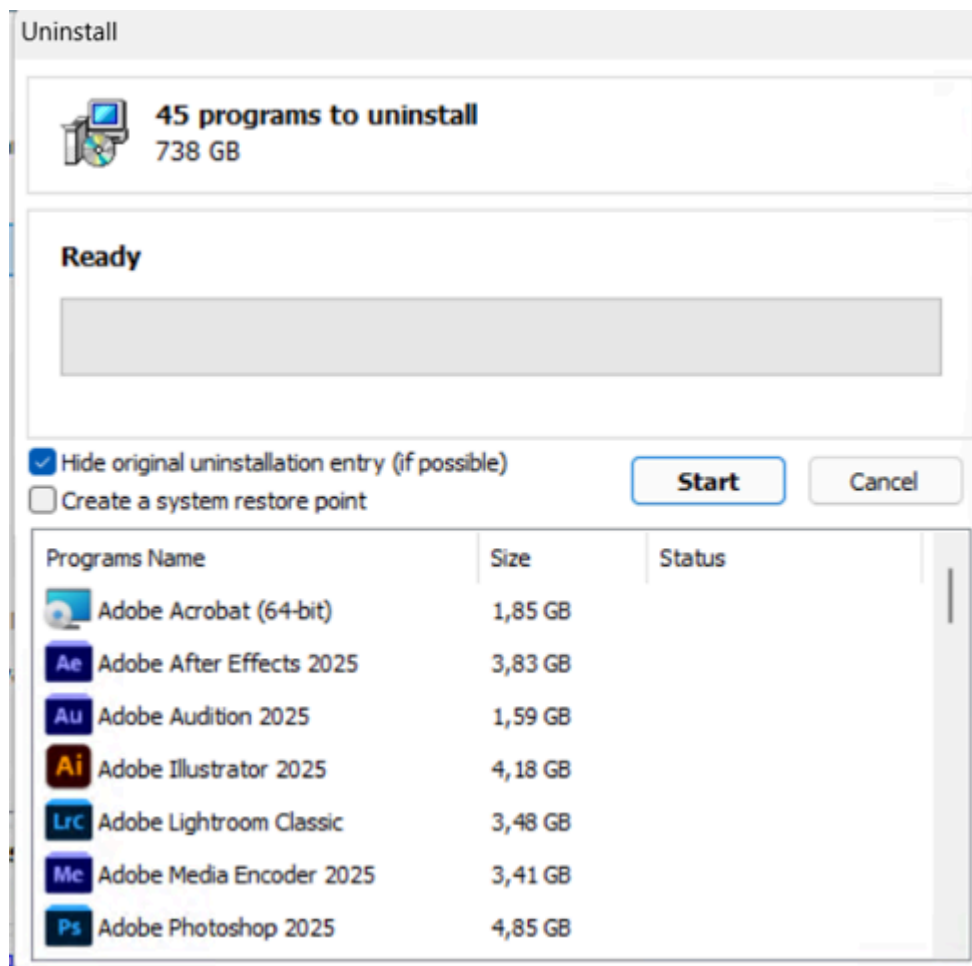
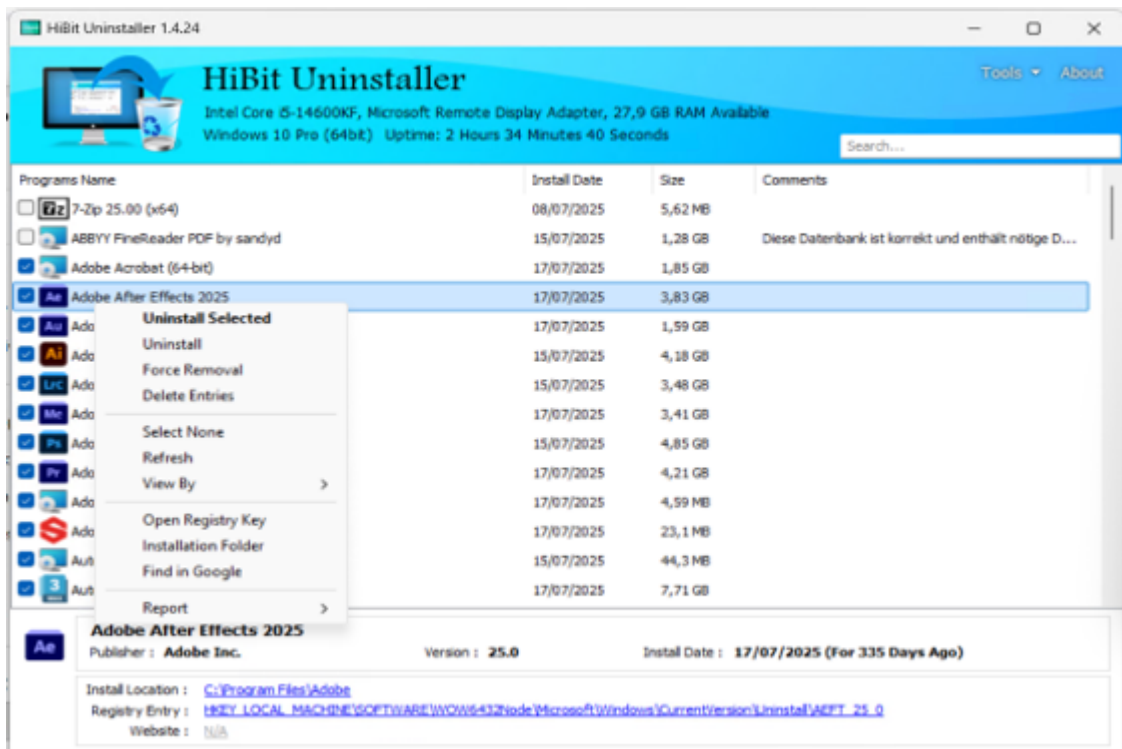
Accounts created by setup: your admin becomes **NextGPU-Authority** ; a new rental account **nextGPU** is created for renters.

Optional: clean the machine

Skip this on a fresh Windows install. Use it when the PC has lots of leftover software or tight disk space.

Tool: [HiBit Uninstaller](#)

1. Install HiBit and review installed apps.
2. Select apps to remove → right-click → **Uninstall Selected**.
3. Click **Start** on the bulk uninstall screen.
4. Reboot before continuing.

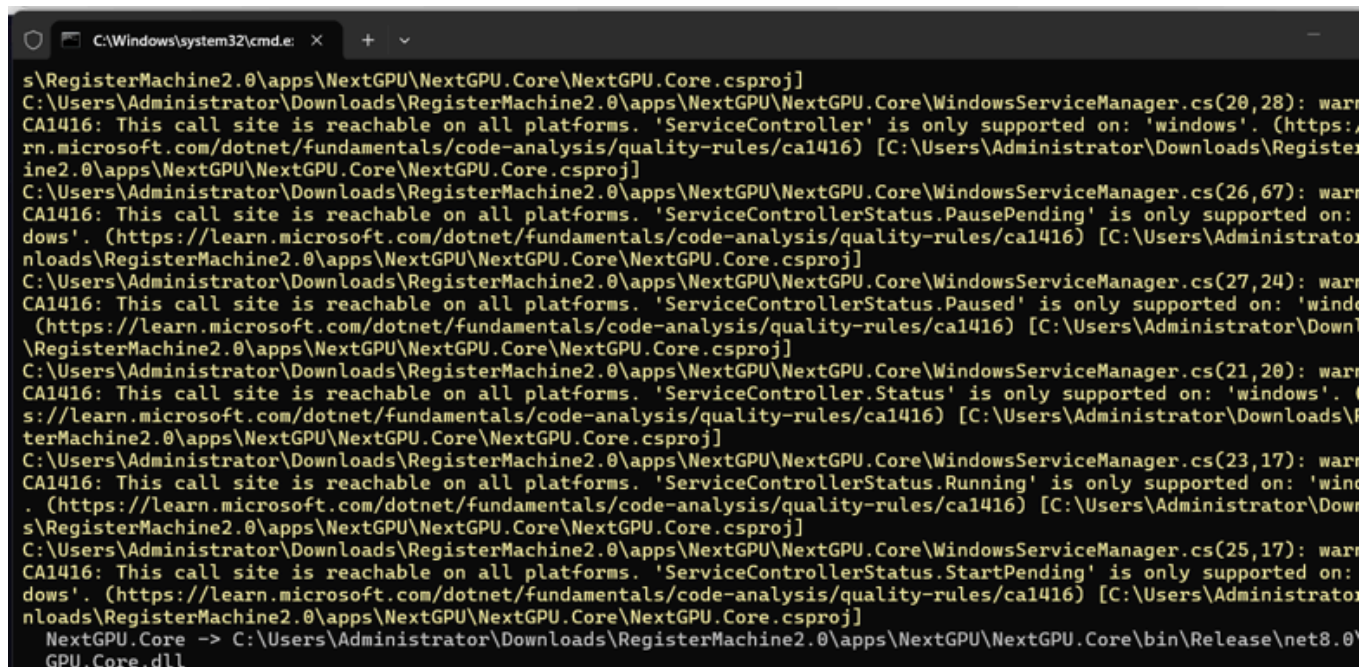


Get the files

1. Download [RegisterMachine.zip](#)
 2. Extract to a **permanent** folder on local **C:** or Downloads
 3. **Do not move the folder later** — PlayNite and other scripts remember this path
-

Install the Controller

1. Open the extracted folder.
2. Double-click **NextGPU.bat** (builds the app on first run — compiler warnings are OK).
3. Click **Yes** if Windows asks for admin permission.
4. Sign in when prompted.



```
C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe X + v
s\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\NextGPU.Core.csproj]
C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\WindowsServiceManager.cs(20,28): warn
CA1416: This call site is reachable on all platforms. 'ServiceController' is only supported on: 'windows'. (https://
rn.microsoft.com/dotnet/fundamentals/code-analysis/quality-rules/ca1416) [C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\Register
ine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\NextGPU.Core.csproj]
C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\WindowsServiceManager.cs(26,67): warn
CA1416: This call site is reachable on all platforms. 'ServiceControllerStatus.PausePending' is only supported on:
dows'. (https://learn.microsoft.com/dotnet/fundamentals/code-analysis/quality-rules/ca1416) [C:\Users\Administrator\
nloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\NextGPU.Core.csproj]
C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\WindowsServiceManager.cs(27,24): warn
CA1416: This call site is reachable on all platforms. 'ServiceControllerStatus.Paused' is only supported on: 'windo
(https://learn.microsoft.com/dotnet/fundamentals/code-analysis/quality-rules/ca1416) [C:\Users\Administrator\Down
\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\NextGPU.Core.csproj]
C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\WindowsServiceManager.cs(21,20): warn
CA1416: This call site is reachable on all platforms. 'ServiceControllerStatus' is only supported on: 'windows'. (
s://learn.microsoft.com/dotnet/fundamentals/code-analysis/quality-rules/ca1416) [C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\
terMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\NextGPU.Core.csproj]
C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\WindowsServiceManager.cs(23,17): warn
CA1416: This call site is reachable on all platforms. 'ServiceControllerStatus.Running' is only supported on: 'wind
. (https://learn.microsoft.com/dotnet/fundamentals/code-analysis/quality-rules/ca1416) [C:\Users\Administrator\Down
s\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\NextGPU.Core.csproj]
C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\WindowsServiceManager.cs(25,17): warn
CA1416: This call site is reachable on all platforms. 'ServiceControllerStatus.StartPending' is only supported on:
dows'. (https://learn.microsoft.com/dotnet/fundamentals/code-analysis/quality-rules/ca1416) [C:\Users\Administrator
nloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\NextGPU.Core.csproj]
NextGPU.Core -> C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\bin\Release\net8.0\
GPU.Core.dll
```



```
Administrator: C:\Windows\Sy x + v
[*] Building NextGPU Controller...
=====
NextGPU Controller - Build and Publish
=====

[*] Installed SDK: 8.0.422 [C:\Program Files\dotnet\sdk]
[*] Using dotnet 8.0.422
[*] Publishing win-x64 self-contained single-file...
Determining projects to restore...
All projects are up-to-date for restore.
NextGPU.Core -> C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.Core\bin\Release\net8.0\NextGPU.Core.dll
NextGPU.App -> C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\NextGPU.App\bin\Release\net8.0-windows\win-x64\NextGPU.dll
NextGPU.App -> C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\publish\
[*] Copying to repo root for NextGPU.bat launcher...
The process cannot access the file because it is being used by another process.
[] Could not copy to repo root; use apps\NextGPU\publish\NextGPU.exe

=====
Build complete
=====
Run: C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\...\NextGPU.bat
Or: C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\apps\NextGPU\...\NextGPU.exe
Login: bluefml / letmeinpls
=====
[*] NextGPU ready: double-click C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\NextGPU.bat

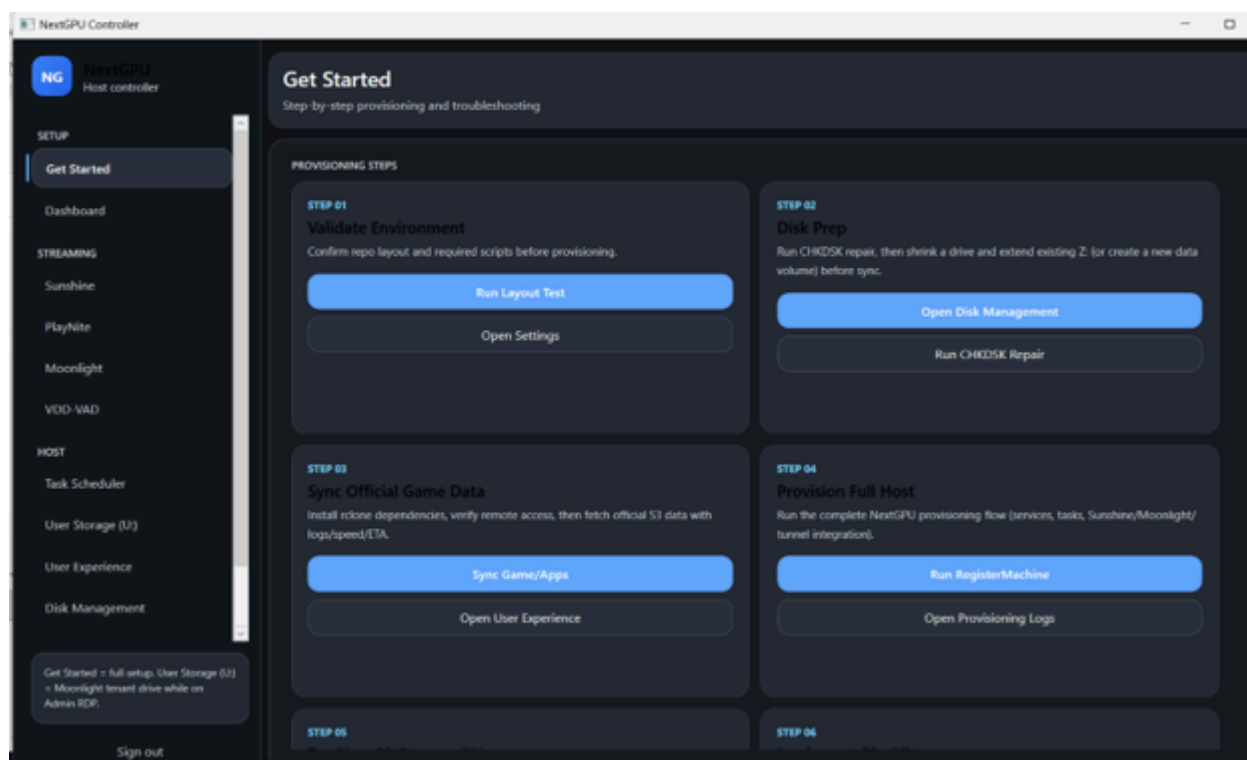
[*] Reboot manually when convenient to finish driver and account changes.
Press any key to continue . . . |
```

After sign-in you land on **Get Started** with **STEP 01–07** — Guide Steps 1–7 below match those cards.

Step 1 — Check the machine (STEP 01)

Controller: STEP 01 — Validate Environment

Button: Run Layout Test





Repo root: C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0

[OK] Root setup launcher
[OK] Root uninstall launcher
[OK] Main setup script
[OK] Uninstall script
[OK] Uninstall wrapper
[OK] Default-user hive helper
[OK] Shutdown policy
[OK] Logon task helper
[OK] Wallpaper policy
[OK] Hive release helper
[OK] nextGPU desktop cleanup
[OK] nextGPU desktop logon task
[OK] Sunshine display ID
[OK] Sunshine log device_id parser
[OK] Sunshine logon task
[OK] Sunshine session start
[OK] NVIDIA session start
[OK] Sunshine API restart helper
[OK] Sunshine config and script deploy
[OK] Sunshine VDD output_name setup
[OK] Post-Sunshine setup orchestrator
[OK] Shared Sunshine/Moonlight stack update
[OK] Streaming stack batch wrapper
[OK] Auto-repair
[OK] Heartbeat
[OK] Scheduled task common helper
[OK] Scheduled task BAT runner
[OK] Heartbeat scheduled task
[OK] Auto-repair scheduled task
[OK] Auto-update scheduled task
[OK] NVIDIA logon scheduled task
[OK] EndSession scheduled task
[OK] Task scheduler orchestrator
[OK] User S3 storage common
[OK] User S3 mount
[OK] User S3 unmount
[OK] User S3 rclone config
[OK] User S3 scheduled tasks
[OK] User S3 setup wrapper
[OK] User S3 Sunshine session hook
[OK] User S3 admin mount trigger
[OK] User S3 troubleshoot
[OK] Wallpaper asset

Optional PlayNiteWatcher (step 05)...

Success: Every line shows [OK] and you see **All layout checks passed.**

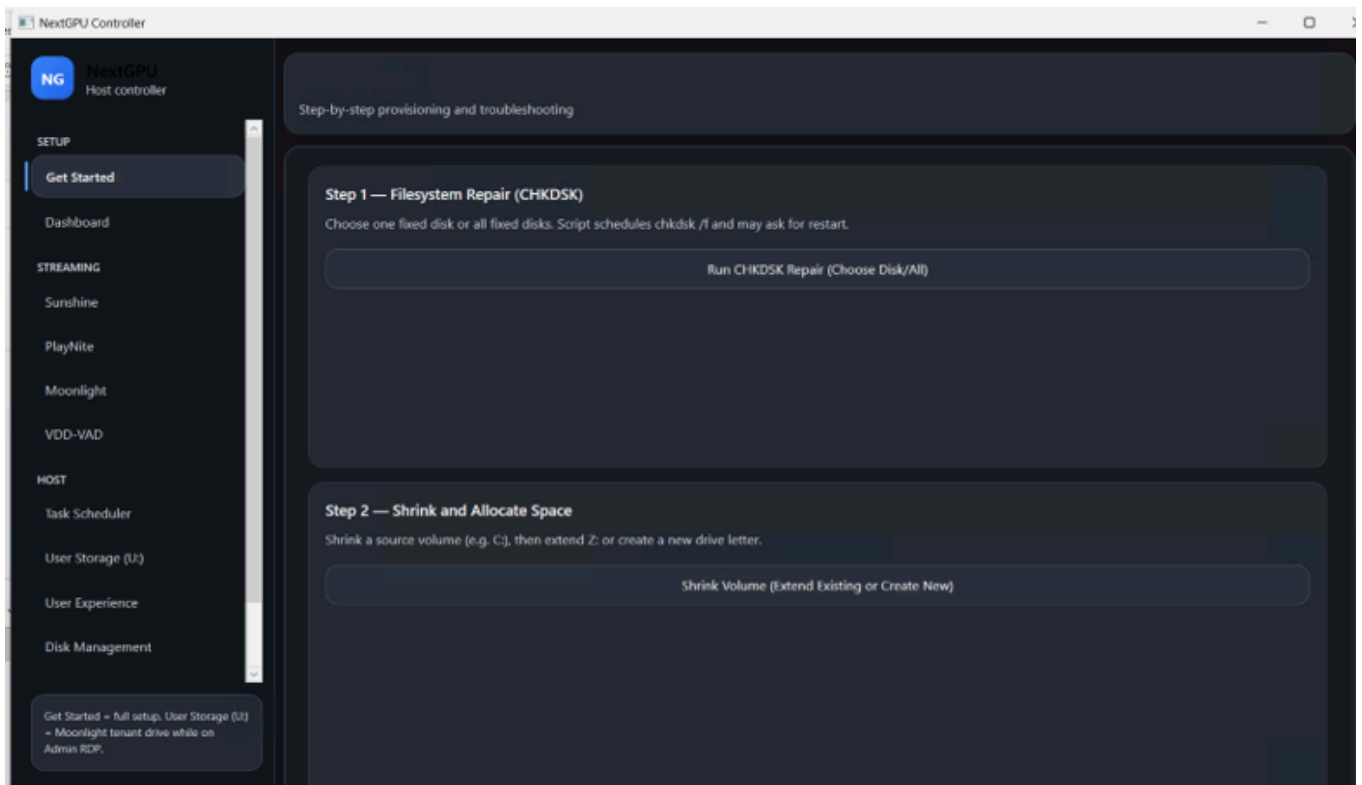
If it fails: Re-extract the zip fresh. Fix every [FAIL] before continuing.

Details: [machine-setup-beginner.md#step-1-check-the-machine-is-ready](#)

Step 2 — Prepare Z: drive (STEP 02)

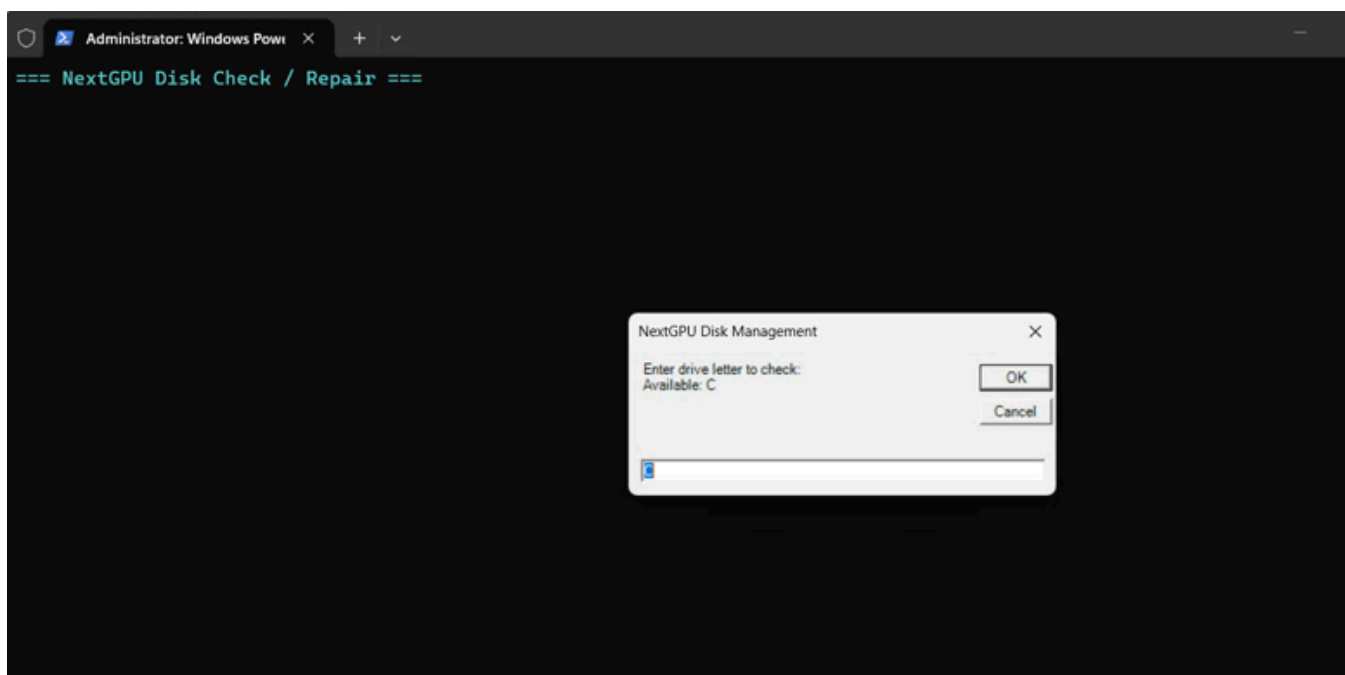
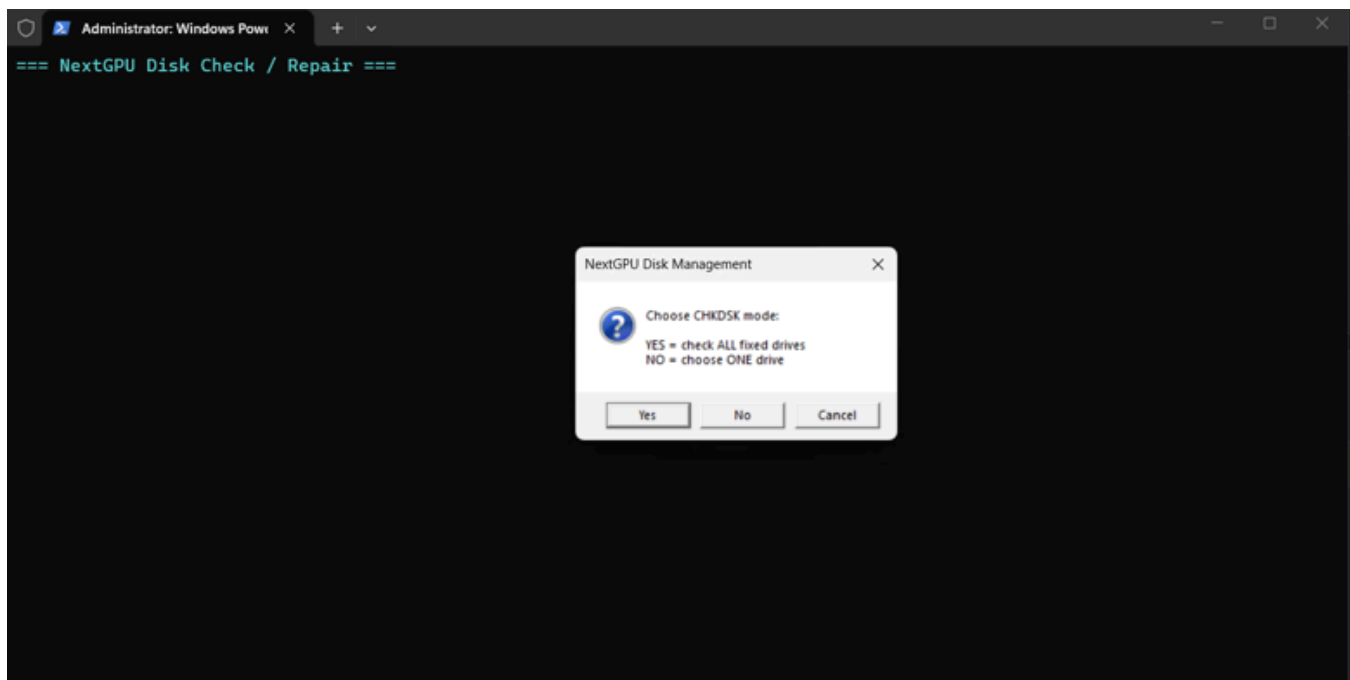
Controller: STEP 02 — Disk Prep

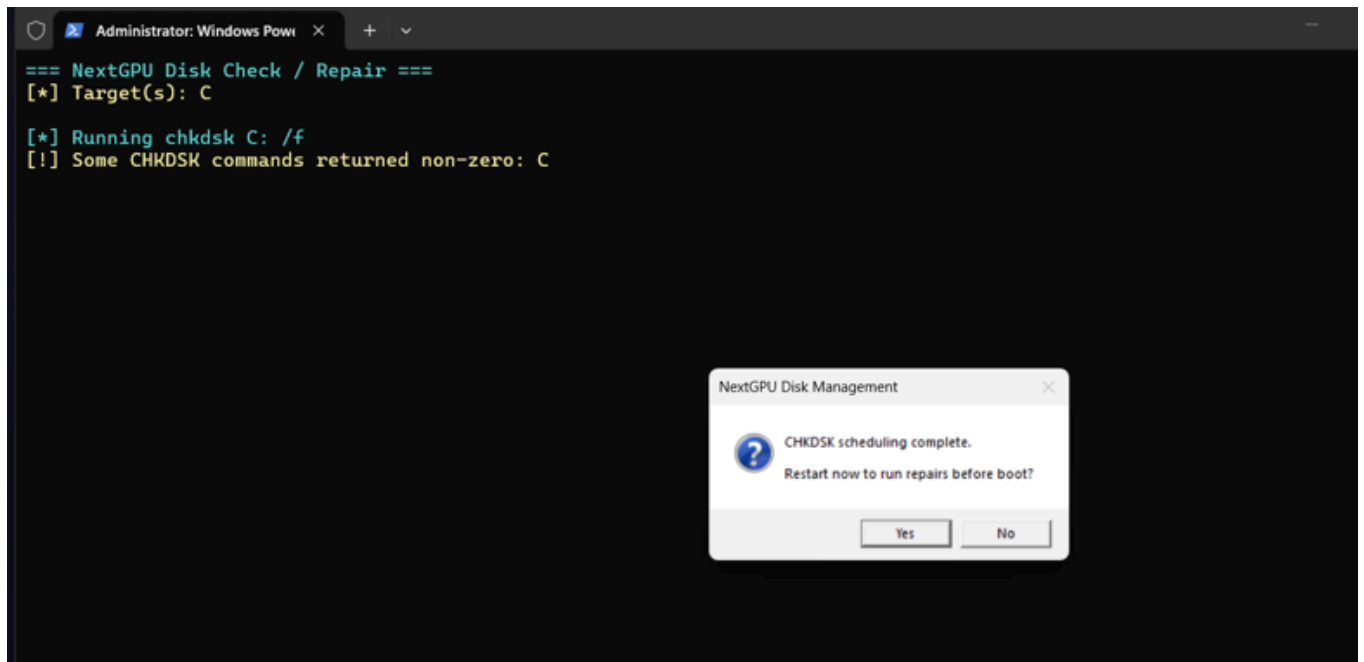
Buttons: Open Disk Management → Run CHKDSK Repair → Shrink Volume (Extend Existing or Create New)



2a. CHKDSK (run first)

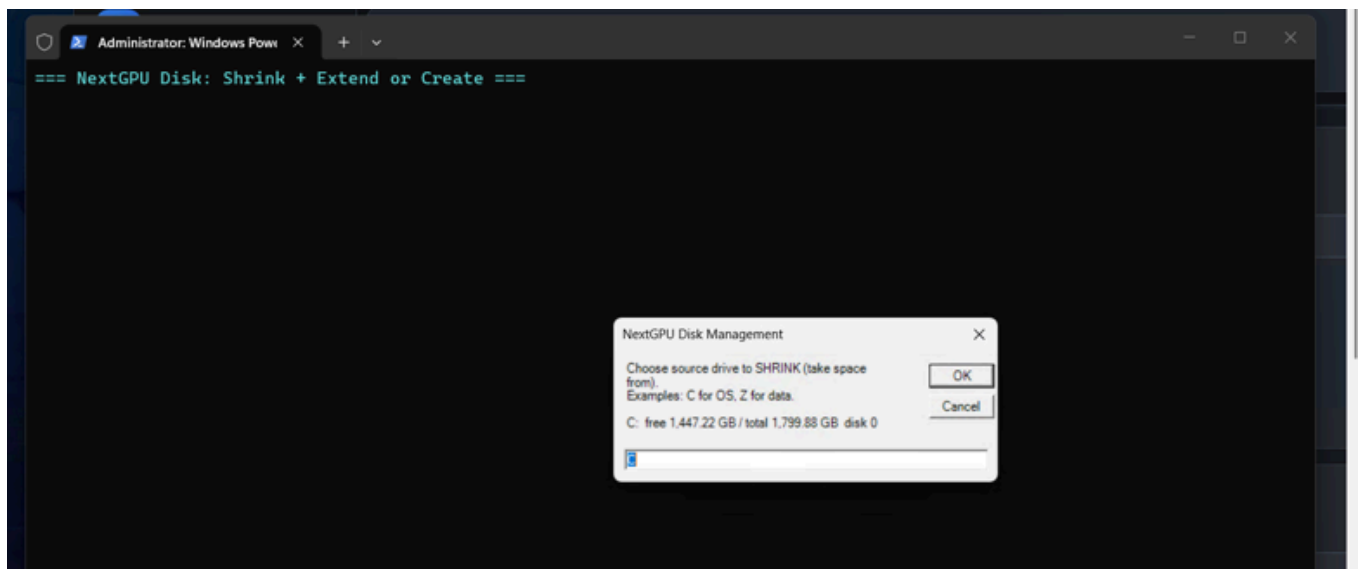
1. Click **Run CHKDSK Repair**.
2. **Yes** = check all drives; **No** = pick one drive (usually **C**).
3. If prompted to restart for repairs, allow it.

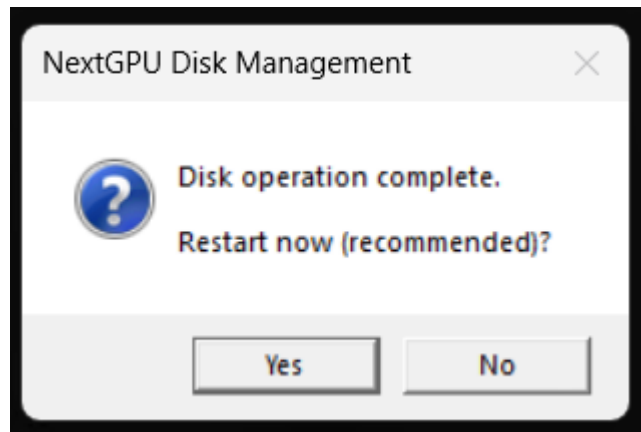
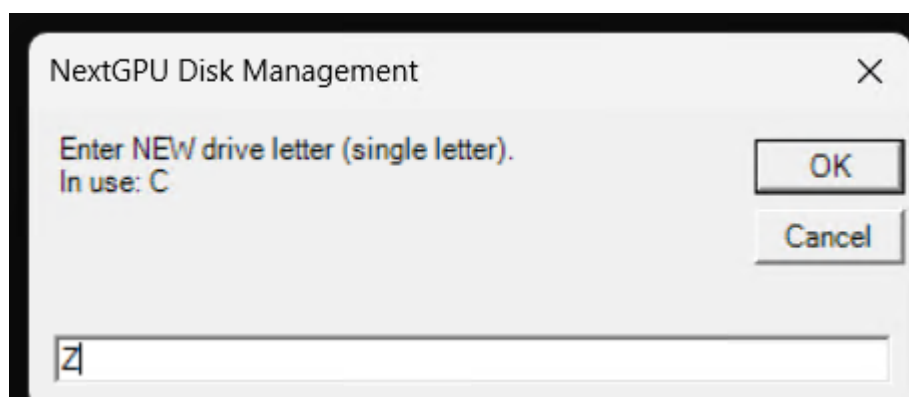
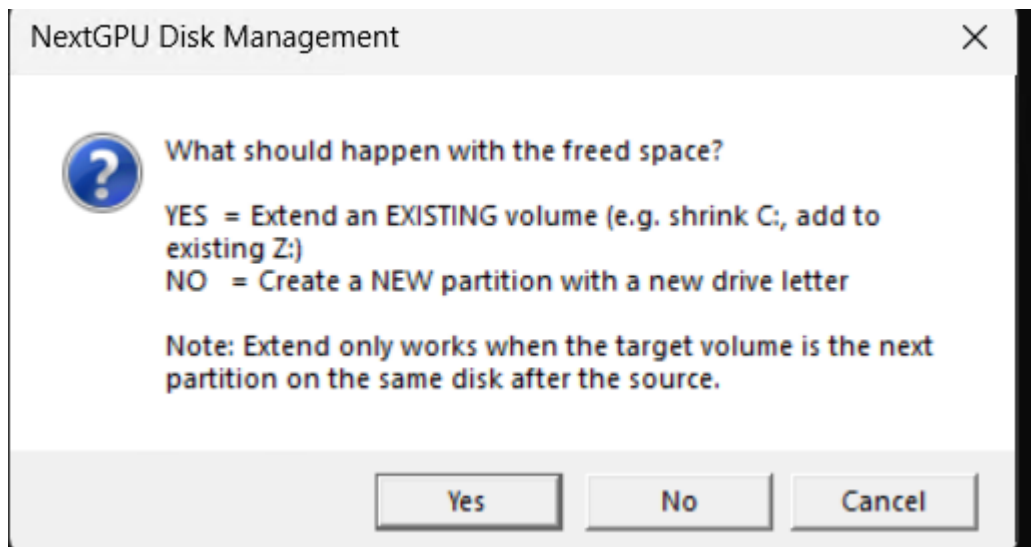




2b. Shrink and create Z:

1. Click **Shrink Volume**.
2. Choose source drive (**C:**).
3. **No** = create a **new** partition (pick this if **Z:** does not exist yet).
4. Enter drive letter **Z** .
5. Restart when disk operation completes.





Success:

Drive	Use
C:	Windows
Z:	Games, apps, PlayNite

Shrink fails? Run `powercfg /h off` , move page file, clear restore points, reboot, retry.

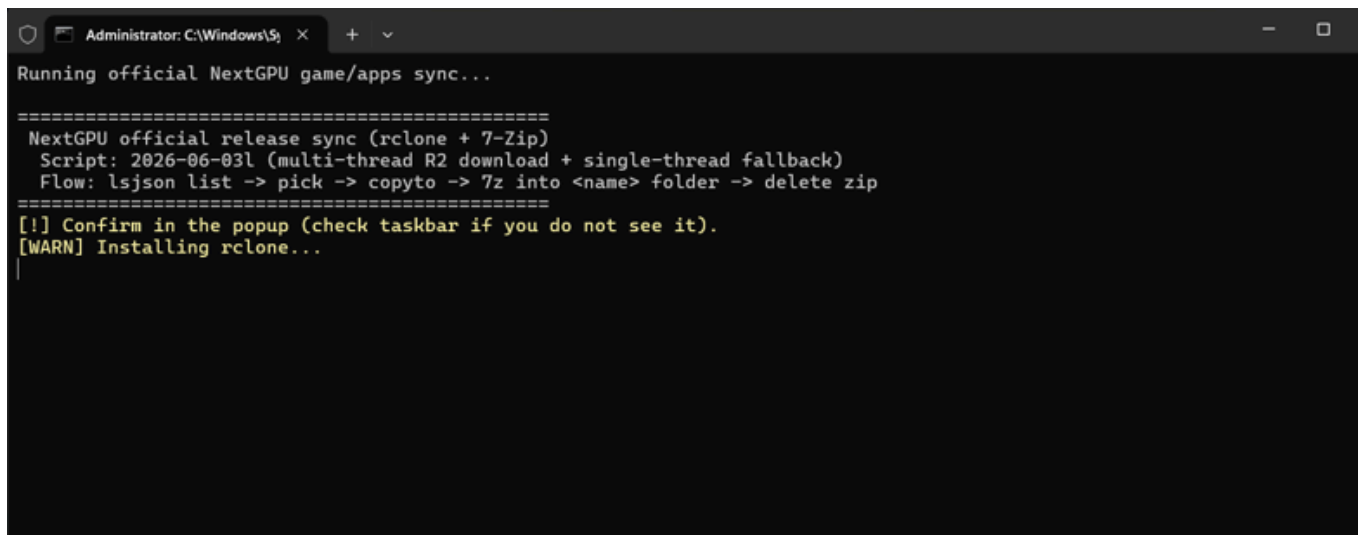
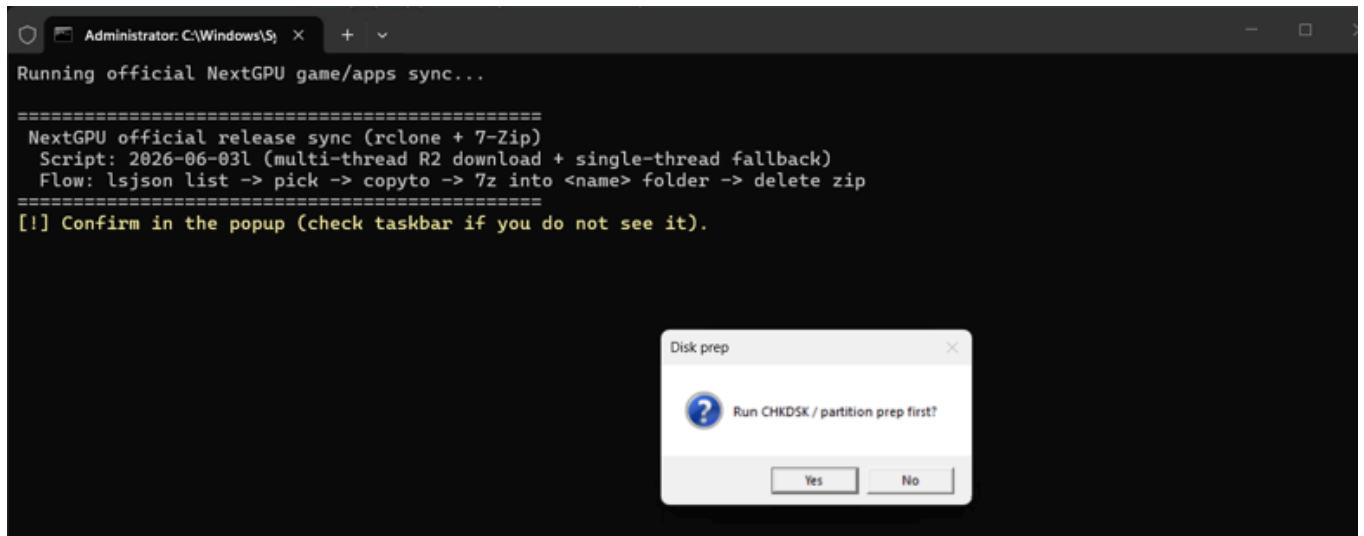
Details: [machine-setup-beginner.md#step-2-prepare-a-drive-for-games](#)

Step 3 — Sync games/apps (STEP 03)

Controller: STEP 03 — Sync Official Game Data

Button: Sync Game/Apps

1. If asked **Run CHKDSK / partition prep first?** → click **No** (you already did Step 2).
2. Wait for **rclone** and **WinFsp** to install if prompted.
3. Enter R2 credentials when asked (access key, secret key, Cloudflare Account ID).
4. Check the archives you want → OK.



```
Administrator: C:\Windows\Sy x + v
Running official NextGPU game/apps sync...

=====
NextGPU official release sync (rclone + 7-Zip)
Script: 2026-06-03l (multi-thread R2 download + single-thread fallback)
Flow: lsjson list -> pick -> copyto -> 7z into <name> folder -> delete zip
=====
[!] Confirm in the popup (check taskbar if you do not see it).
[WARN] Installing rclone...
Found Rclone [Rclone.Rclone] Version 1.74.3
This application is licensed to you by its owner.
Microsoft is not responsible for, nor does it grant any licenses to, third-party packages.
Downloading https://github.com/rclone/rclone/releases/download/v1.74.3/rclone-v1.74.3-windows-amd64.zip
11.0 MB / 27.9 MB
```

NextGPU Sync (R2) X

R2 access_key_id

OK

Cancel

NextGPU Sync (R2) _ □ X

R2 secret_access_key

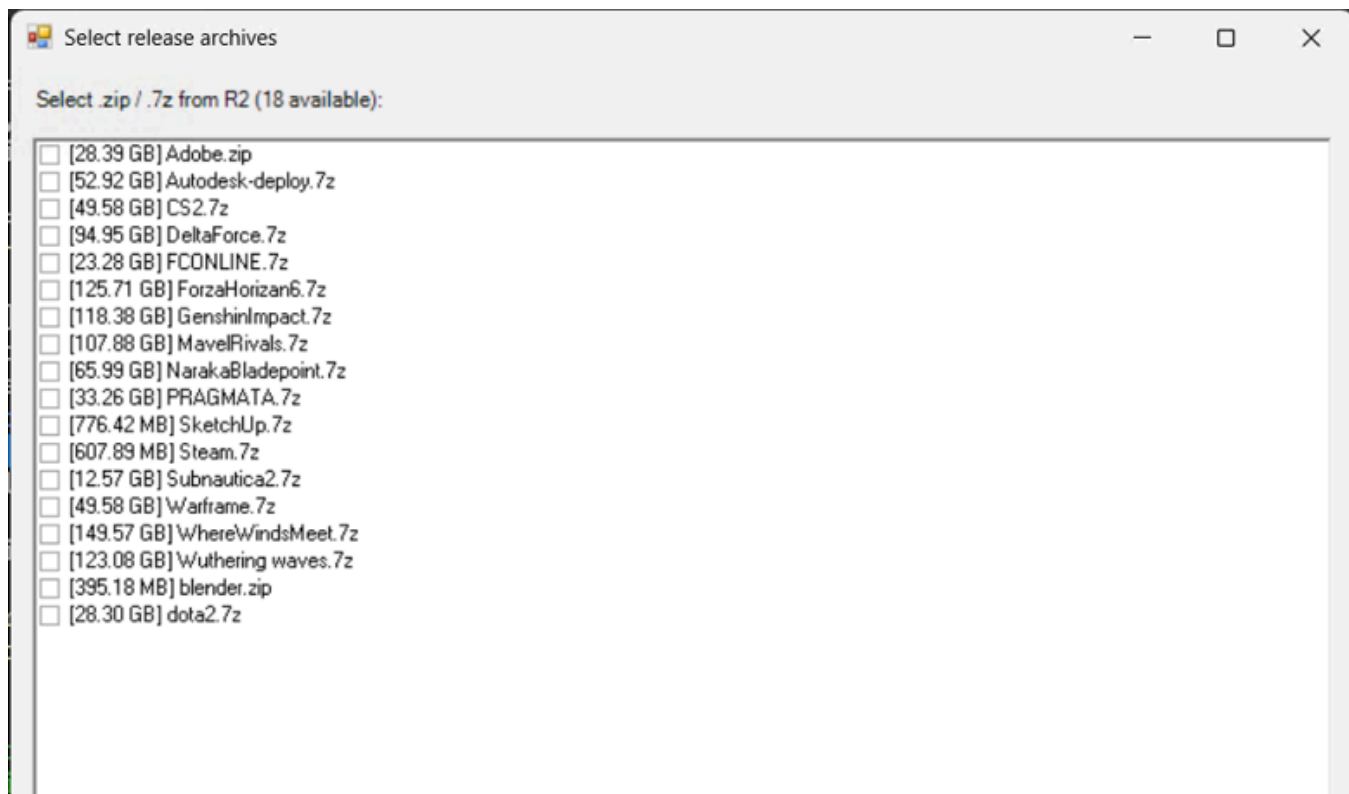
OK Cancel

NextGPU Sync (R2) X

Cloudflare Account ID (R2 S3 API)

OK

Cancel



Success: Selected folders exist on `Z:` (e.g. `Z:\Steam`). No `[FAIL]` in the log.

Details: [machine-setup-beginner.md#step-3-download-the-official-gamesapps](https://github.com/nextgpu/machine-setup-beginner.md#step-3-download-the-official-gamesapps)

Step 4 — RegisterMachine (STEP 04)

Controller: STEP 04 — Provision Full Host

Button: Run RegisterMachine

Have credentials from [Before you start](#) ready.

1. Click **Yes** for admin permission.
2. Fill the **Register Machine — Configuration** form (secrets are masked):
 - **Install VDD/VAD** — **Yes** for headless streaming; **No** if this machine uses a physical monitor only
 - Cloudflare API Token, Account ID, API Key
 - Computer Name, Original Price, Vendor ID (optional)
 - **NextGPU-Admin password** — required; used for RunAsTool and session management (stored with DPAPI)
 - Admin account to rename → becomes `NextGPU-Authority`
3. Click **Run Register Machine**. An elevated console continues setup.
4. Wait for unattended provisioning to finish.
5. **Reboot** when prompted.

6. After reboot, open `domain.txt` and test the URL in a browser (Moonlight Web should load).

Register Machine — Configuration

Required Configuration

Fill in provisioning details. Secrets are masked. The elevated console will run setup after you confirm.

INSTALL VDD/VAD

Yes

Virtual display + audio for headless streaming. Choose No if this machine uses a physical monitor only.

CLOUDFLARE API TOKEN

Paste Cloudflare API token

CLOUDFLARE ACCOUNT ID

API KEY

Paste API key

COMPUTER NAME

Cancel

Run Register Machine

Register Machine — Configuration

Required Configuration

Fill in provisioning details. Secrets are masked. The elevated console will run setup after you confirm.

ORIGINAL PRICE

10.99

VENDOR ID (OPTIONAL)

NEXTGPU-ADMIN PASSWORD

Enter password for NextGPU-Admin

Required for RunAsTool and session management. Stored securely with DPAPI.

ADMIN ACCOUNT TO RENAME

NextGPU-Authority

Renamed to NextGPU-Authority during setup.

Cancel

Run Register Machine

Wrong credentials? Close the console / cancel, then run Step 4 again with corrected values.

Details: [machine-setup-beginer.md#step-4-run-the-main-setup-registermachine](#)

Step 5 — Renter storage (U:) (STEP 05)

Controller: STEP 05 — Per-User S3 Storage (U:)

Requires: Step 4 finished (`domain.txt` exists).

Button: One-Click S3 Setup

1. Enter S3 Access Key and Secret Key when prompted.
2. Save credentials → **Y**; set machine env vars → **Y**.
3. Wait for setup to complete.

```
Administrator: nextGPU User x + v
=====
Setup (one-time logon mount for nextGPU)
=====
User: ADMIN-PC\NextGPU-Authority
Scripts: C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\scripts\runtime (launch: C:\Users\Administrator\Down
RegisterMachine2.0\scripts\runtime)
Logs: C:\ProgramData\nextGPU\logs
[*] Install scripts: C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\scripts\runtime
[OK] domain.txt at C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0
[*] (1/3) Installing rclone + WinFsp...

Logs: C:\ProgramData\nextGPU\logs
[*] Install scripts: C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0\scripts\runtime
[OK] domain.txt at C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0
[*] (1/3) Installing rclone + WinFsp...

[
A
AWS Secret Access Key (input hidden): *****
Save credentials on this machine? [Y/n]: Y
Also set machine environment variables (recommended for logon tasks)? [Y/n]: Y
```

```
Administrator: nextGPU User x + v
[*] Mount trigger: RemoteConnect (+20s reconnect; mount only when USER=nextGPU).
[*] Mount trigger: ConsoleConnect (+20s reconnect; mount only when USER=nextGPU).
[*] Registered: nextGPU-UserStorageMount (BUILTIN\Users logon +22s; recreate-safe, mounts only for nextGPU).
[*] Unmount trigger: RemoteDisconnect for ADMIN-PC\nextGPU (Moonlight / RDP disconnect).
[*] Registered: nextGPU-UserStorageUnmount (1 unmount triggers for ADMIN-PC\nextGPU).
[2026-06-17 19:23:52] [OK] Register-UserStorageTasks.ps1 completed on ADMIN-PC
[2026-06-17 19:23:52] [OK] Saved repo root marker: C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0
[*] Repo root for domain.txt: C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0
[*] nextGPU can read domain.txt and run scripts under C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\RegisterMachine2.0 (repo not move
d).
Tasks use C:\ProgramData\nextGPU\scripts\runtime (set up via Setup-UserStorage.bat).
[OK] Mount task: BUILTIN\Users; unmount task: nextGPU.
[OK] Logon auto-mount: nextGPU sign-in -> U: within ~22s (no manual Mount).
[OK] Sync complete.

--- Mount readiness ---
[OK] rclone config
[OK] rclone readable
[OK] rclone exe
[OK] winfsp
[OK] published scripts
[OK] domain copy
[OK] rental access
[OK] domain txt
[OK] Setup complete.
Renter: sign in as nextGPU -> U: auto-mounts ~22s (BUILTIN\Users logon task).
Recreated nextGPU: no task re-bind needed; same Users-group task runs Mount-UserStorage.ps1.
Logs: C:\ProgramData\nextGPU\logs
Press any key to continue
```

Confirm: Log in as `nextGPU`, wait ~22 seconds — `U:` appears as **{Name}'s Storage**.

Missing U:? Controller → **User Storage** → **Diagnose & fix**.

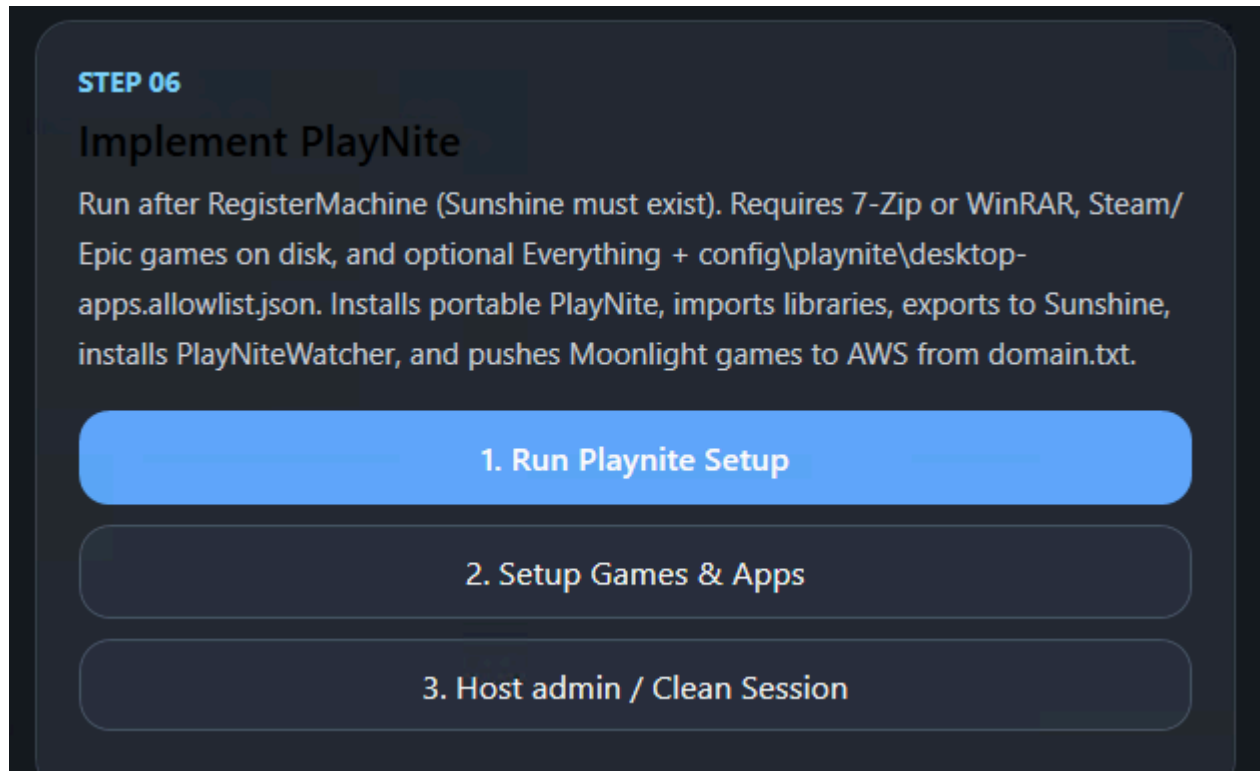
Details: [machine-setup-beginer.md#step-5-set-up-renter-storage-the-u-drive](#)

Step 6 — PlayNite (STEP 06)

Controller: STEP 06 — Implement PlayNite

Requires: Step 4 finished (Sunshine installed).

In the Controller this is **STEP 06 — Implement PlayNite** (three buttons after setup finishes).

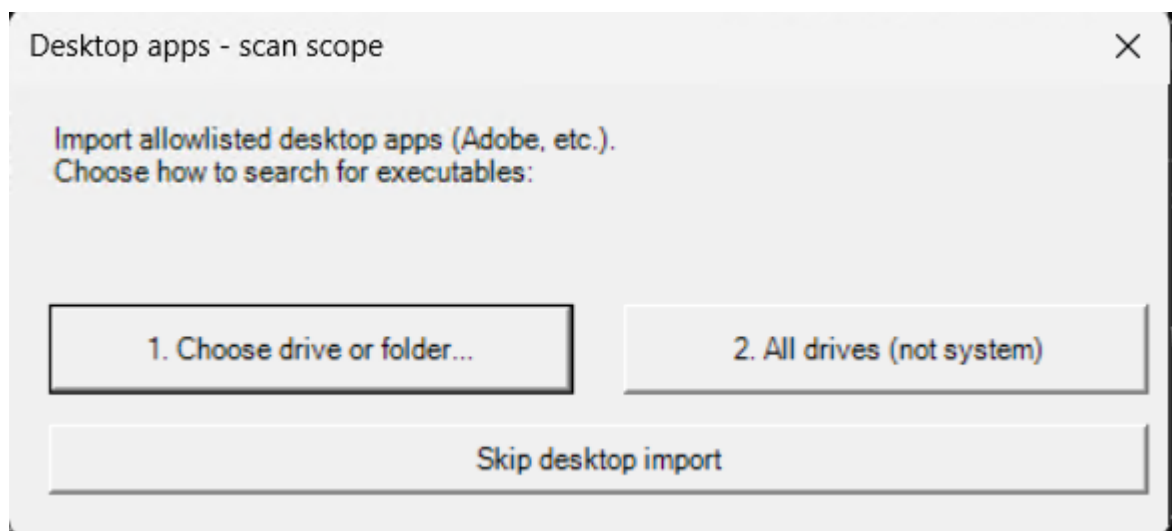
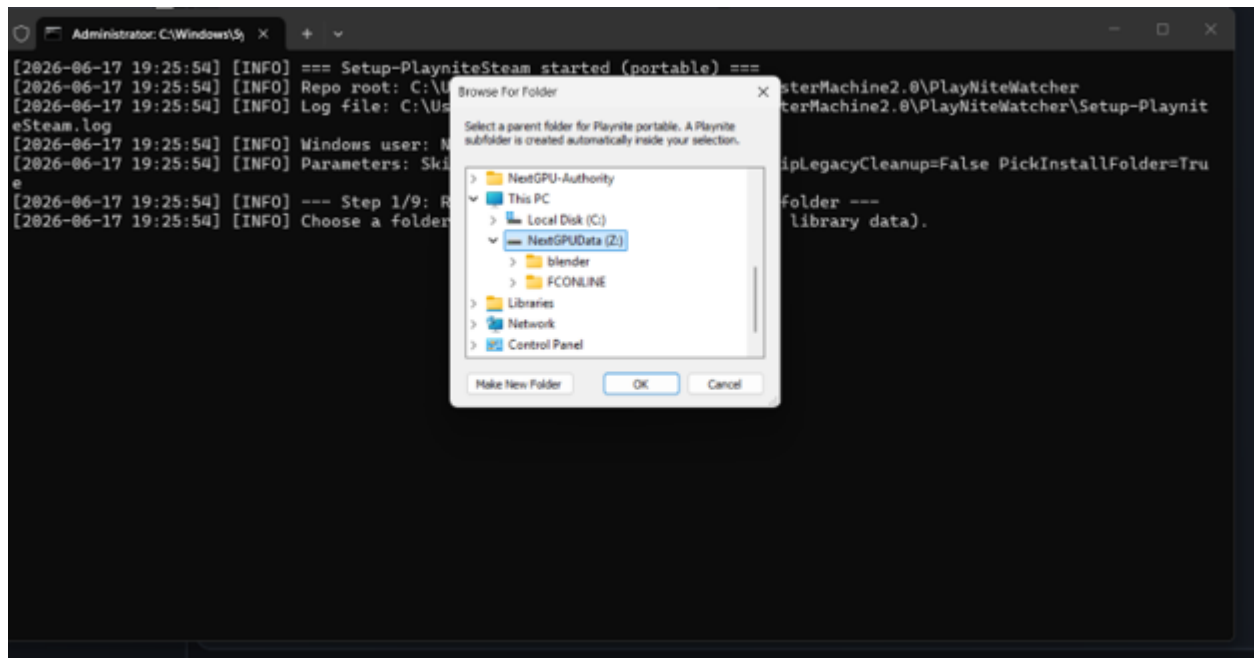


Buttons on the card: 1. Run Playnite Setup, 2. Setup Games & Apps, 3. Host admin / Clean Session (opens **Bypass** — admin account, service, Steam ACL, allowlist elevation, Clean Session).

1. Run Playnite Setup

Button: 1. Run Playnite Setup

1. Pick install folder (e.g. `Z:\` — a **Playnite** subfolder is created).
2. Let it scan Steam/Epic and allowlisted desktop apps.
3. Choose scan scope: specific drive/folder or all non-system drives.
4. Setup exports games to Sunshine.



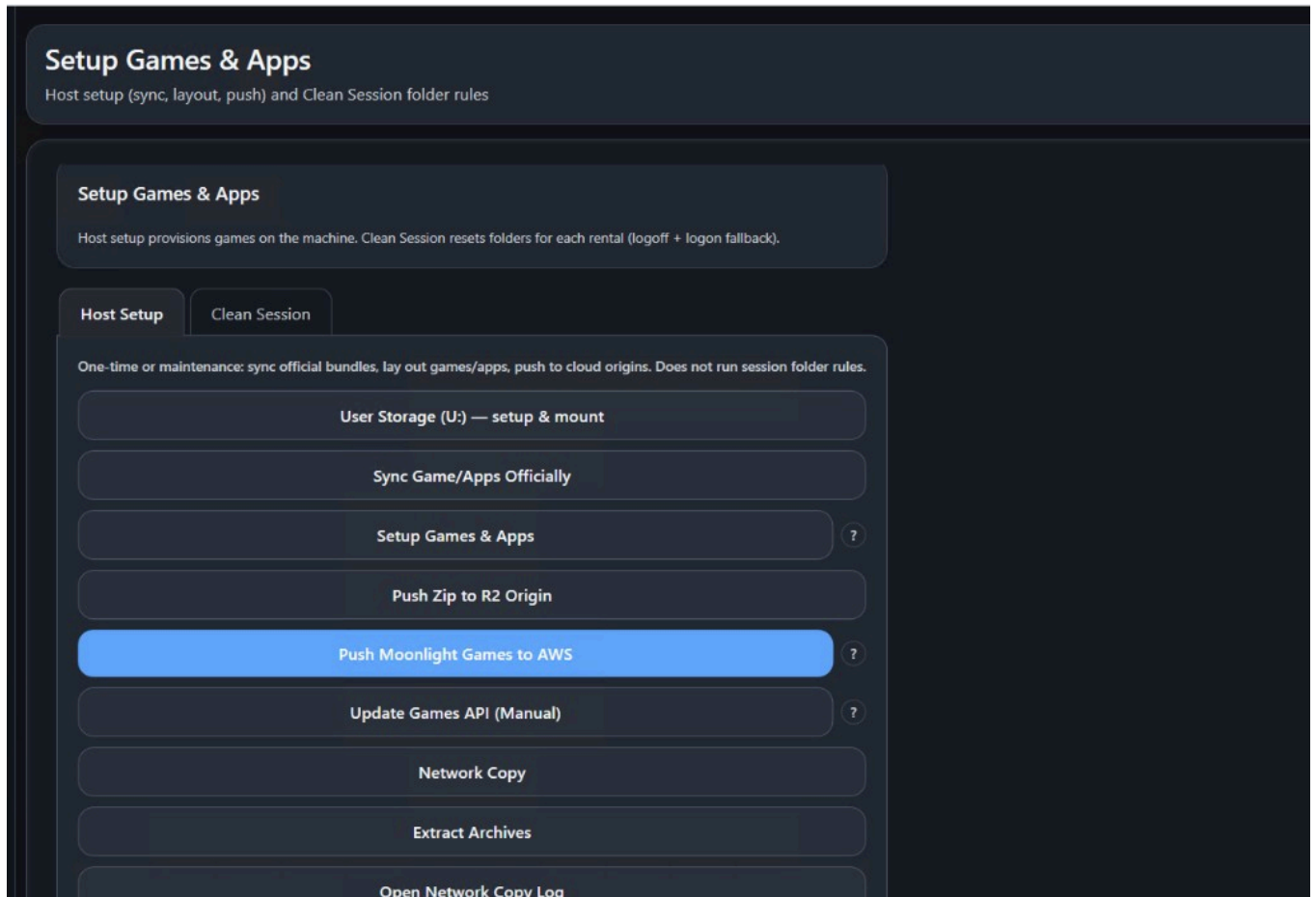
2. Setup Games & Apps (assigned apps only)

Button: 2. Setup Games & Apps

Use this for host layout only — **only for apps NextGPU assigned to this machine**. Clean Session lives in **\$3 Host admin / Clean Session**.

First-time order: steps 1–2 here (arrange) → complete **\$3 Bypass** → return for step 3 (push to AWS).

1. Open **Setup Games & Apps** → **Host Setup** tab.
2. Run **Setup Games & Apps** (arrange) and any sync actions required for your assigned titles. For Garena, this host layout already prepares the session template — you do **not** need **Seed Garena Template** later.

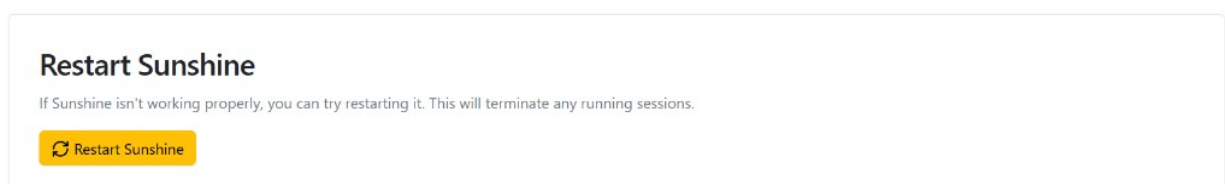


3. **Publish the game list to AWS** — after host layout and **\$3 Bypass** (allowlist + Clean Session if needed) for your assigned apps:

1. Stay on **Setup Games & Apps** → **Host Setup** tab (same page as **Setup Games & Apps** arrange).
2. Click **Push Moonlight Games to AWS**.
3. Confirm `computer_name` and `publicIP` from `domain.txt` → **Yes**.
4. Wait until the console shows **SUCCESS**.

When to run again: after you add or change games on disk, re-run arrange/sync for those apps, then **Push Moonlight Games to AWS** again.

If push fails: Controller → **Sunshine** → **Restart Sunshine**, then push again.

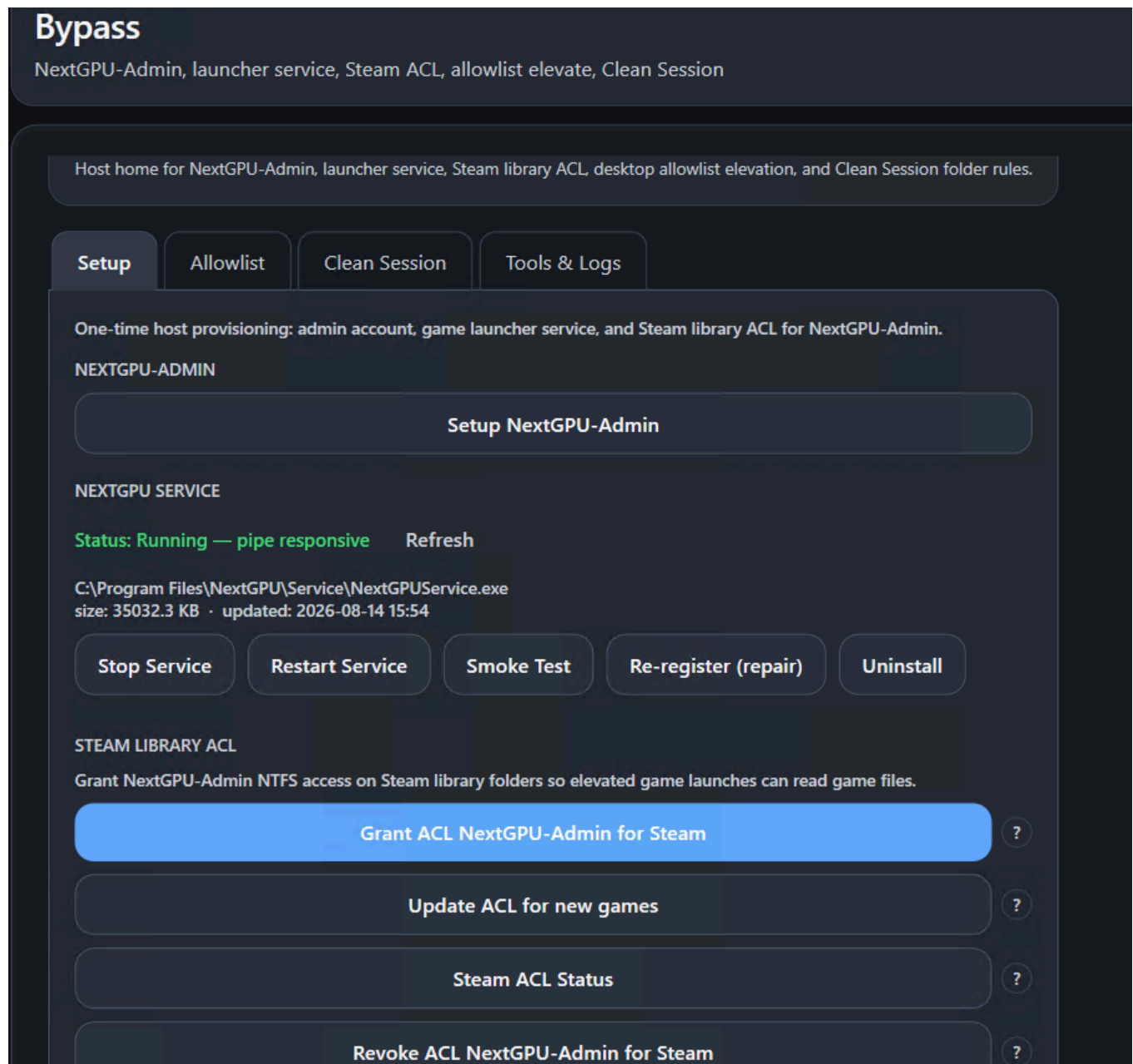


3. Host admin / Clean Session (Bypass — assigned apps only)

Button: 3. Host admin / Clean Session (opens **Bypass**)

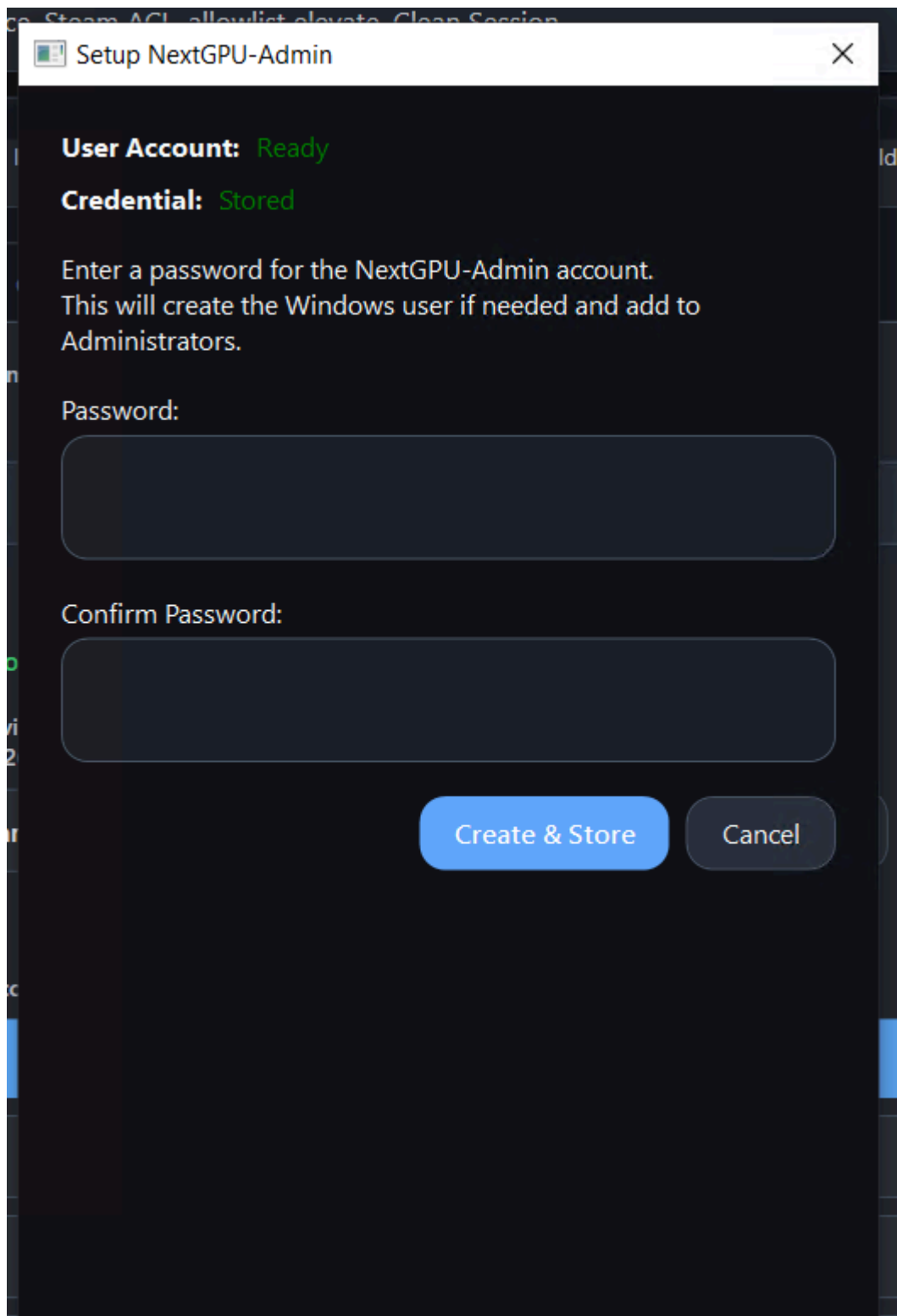
Configure **only apps on your assigned list**. Bypass has four tabs: **Setup**, **Allowlist**, **Clean Session**, **Tools & Logs**.

Setup tab — admin account, service, Steam ACL



NextGPU-Admin

1. Click **Setup NextGPU-Admin**.
2. Check status:
 - **User Account: Ready**
 - **Credential: Stored**
3. If both are green (normal after Register Machine), click **Cancel** — no password needed.
4. If either is missing, enter the Register Machine password (12+ characters) → **Create & Store**.



NextGPU Service

- **Status** should read **Running — pipe responsive** (green). Click **Refresh** if unsure.
- **Smoke Test** — pings the service pipe after changes.
- **Re-register (repair)** — refreshes service registration if launches fail.
- **Stop / Restart / Uninstall** — maintenance only; renters need the service running.

Steam Library ACL

Run once after Steam games are on disk, then again when you add titles:

Button	When to use
Grant ACL NextGPU-Admin for Steam	First-time setup on this host
Update ACL for new games	After installing a new Steam game
Steam ACL Status	Check ACL without changing anything
Revoke ACL NextGPU-Admin for Steam	Decommission / troubleshooting only

Allowlist tab — elevated launches

Games and desktop apps that must launch as admin (without a password prompt each rental).

Bypass

NextGPU-Admin, launcher service, Steam ACL, allowlist elevate, Clean Session

Host home for NextGPU-Admin, launcher service, Steam library ACL, desktop allowlist elevation, and Clean Session folder rules.

Setup **Allowlist** Clean Session Tools & Logs

Toggle runAsAdmin on desktop allowlist entries. Re-export to Sunshine after changes so @ADMIN markers reach resolved-appids.txt.

28 app(s) in C:\Users\Admin\Downloads\nextGPU-corescripts\PlayNiteWatcher\config\playnite\desktop-apps.allowlist.json

Refresh
Delete Selected
Open in Notepad

	exe	nameId	title	type	runAsAdmin
☐	Adobe UXP Develo	10000014	Adobe UXP Developer Tools	Adobe	☐
☐	acad.exe	10000101	AutoCAD 2024	Autodesk	☐
☐	Revit.exe	10000102	Revit	Autodesk	☐
☐	3dsmax.exe	10000103	3ds Max	Autodesk	☐
☐	maya.exe	10000104	Autodesk Maya	Autodesk	☐
☐	CapCut.exe	10000201	CapCut	ThirdParty	☐
☐	SketchUp.exe	10000202	SketchUp	ThirdParty	☐
☐	blender.exe	10000203	Blender	ThirdParty	☐
☐	DeltaForceClient.ex	10000302	Delta Force	Games	☒
☐	Level Up.exe	10000303	Naraka Bladepoint	Games	☒
☐	launcher.exe	10000301	Genshin Impact	Games	☒
☐	Garena.exe	10000304	Garena FC Online	Games	☒

runAsAdmin updated for 'Garena FC Online'. Re-export to Sunshine so the @ADMIN marker is emitted into resolved-appids.txt.

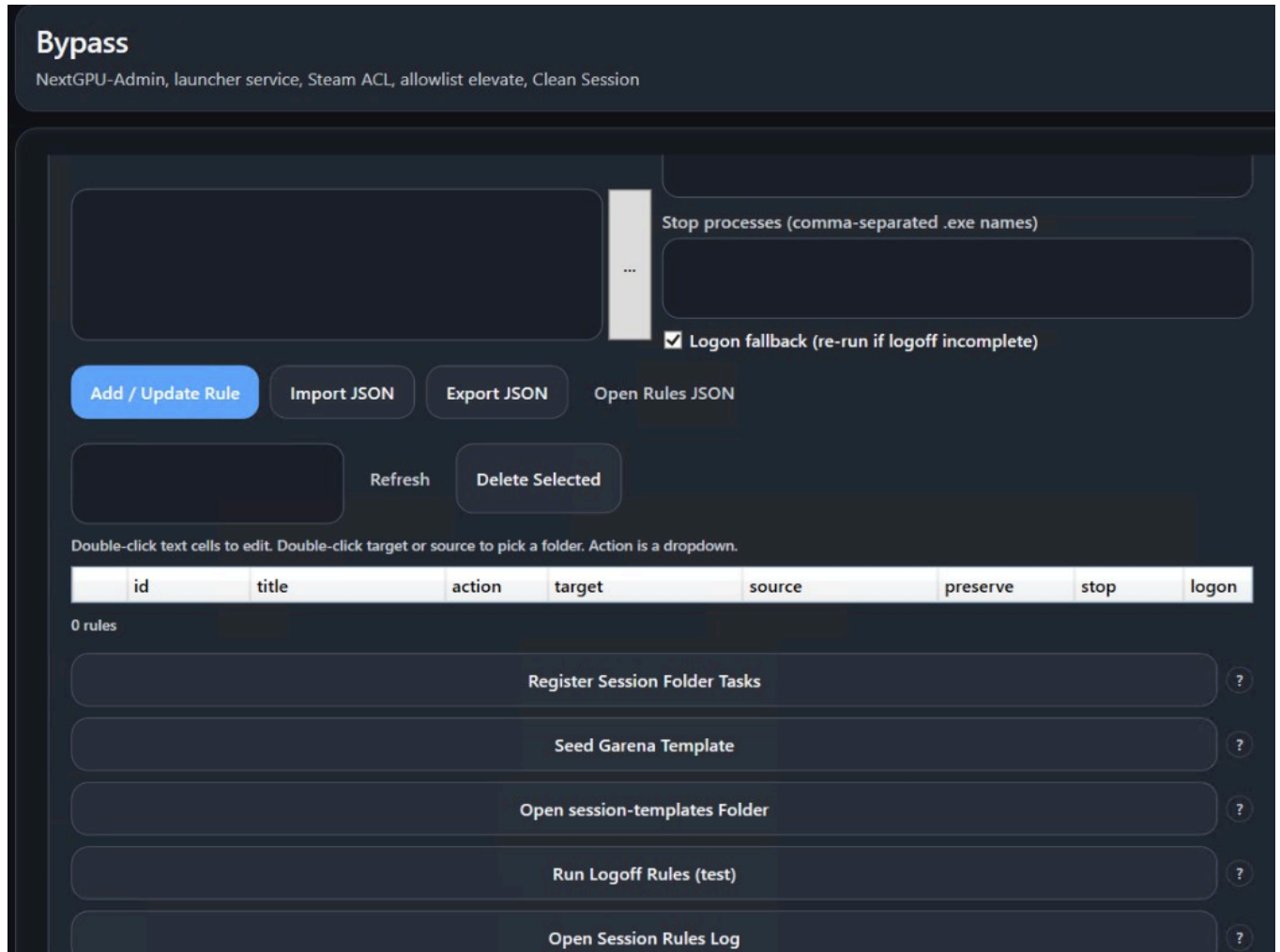
Export Admin launches

1. Open the **Allowlist** tab.
2. Enable **runAsAdmin** only for **assigned** titles that need admin (e.g. Garena FC Online). Leave unassigned rows and productivity apps unchecked.
3. Click **Export Admin launches** — re-exports Playnite + allowlist to Sunshine with **@ADMIN** markers. Confirm the warning (active Moonlight sessions may end).
4. If export fails, **close Playnite completely** and retry **Export Admin launches**. Only one Playnite instance can use `library\games.db` at a time.

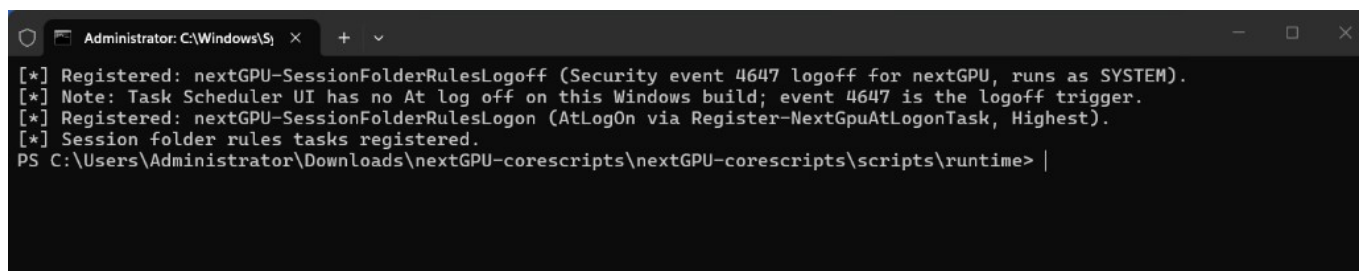
Other controls: **Refresh** reloads the grid; **Delete Selected** removes entries; **Open in Notepad** edits `desktop-apps.allowlist.json` directly.

Clean Session tab — reset folders between rentals

Only if an assigned app needs its data folder wiped or replaced each rental (e.g. Garena).



1. Click **Import JSON** — select the rules file NextGPU provided for this machine's assigned apps.
2. Verify the rules table (id, title, action, target, source, stop, logon). Double-click cells to edit; use **Add / Update Rule** for one-offs.
3. Click **Register Session Folder Tasks** — wait until the console confirms logoff/logon tasks are registered.



Skip **Seed Garena Template** if **Setup Games & Apps** host layout already prepared it.

Button	When to use
Seed Garena Template	Only if Garena template was not created during host layout
Open session-templates Folder	Inspect golden replace sources under ProgramData\nextGPU\session-templates
Run Logoff Rules (test)	Dry-run logoff rules without ending a session
Open Session Rules Log	Troubleshoot rule execution

Notice: Session end runs folder rules **and** deletes/recreates `NextGPU-Admin` . Keep the Register Machine password — it is reused to recreate the account.

More detail: [session/clean-session.md](#)

Tools & Logs tab

Quick links: **Open Steam Library Folder**, **Open ProgramData\nextGPU**, **Open Session Rules Log**, **Open NextGPUService Log**, **Open Admin Setup Log**.

Bypass success: NextGPU-Admin Ready + Stored; service **Running — pipe responsive**; Steam ACL granted; **runAsAdmin** set and **Export Admin launches** done for assigned admin titles; Clean Session tasks registered when required.

Details: [machine-setup-beginner.md#step-6-add-games-with-playnite](#)

Step 7 — Final check (STEP 07)

Controller: STEP 07 — Verify Host Is Ready

Button: `Run Wallpaper Verification` , then work through this list:

#	Check	Good looks like
1	Streaming	nextGPU login → Moonlight stream, no black screen; picture scales to client's requested resolution (see wrong scaling)
2	Wallpaper	Verification [OK], image not stretched
3	Drivers	VDD/VAD in Device Manager
4	Services	cloudflared, moonlight-web, gpu-heartbeat, auto-repair running
5	U: drive	Appears after nextGPU logon (~22s)
6	Games	Show in Moonlight app list
7	Logs	No repeated failures

Test like a renter

1. Open `domain.txt` URL in a browser (ideally another device).
2. Confirm Moonlight Web loads and a test stream starts.

One more reboot

Reboot once more and recheck streaming, services, and U: drive. When all seven checks pass, the machine is ready to list.

Details: [machine-setup-beginner.md#step-7-final-check-before-going-live](#)

If something goes wrong

Find the symptom below. For full detail (VDD `device_id` JSON, log paths, etc.), see [machine-setup-beginner.md#if-something-goes-wrong](#).

Black screen when streaming starts

Try, in order:

1. Controller → start Sunshine within the active session (not only as a background service).
2. **Sunshine** page → restart API / refresh display.
3. Re-apply wallpaper.
4. Reboot if you just installed the virtual display driver.

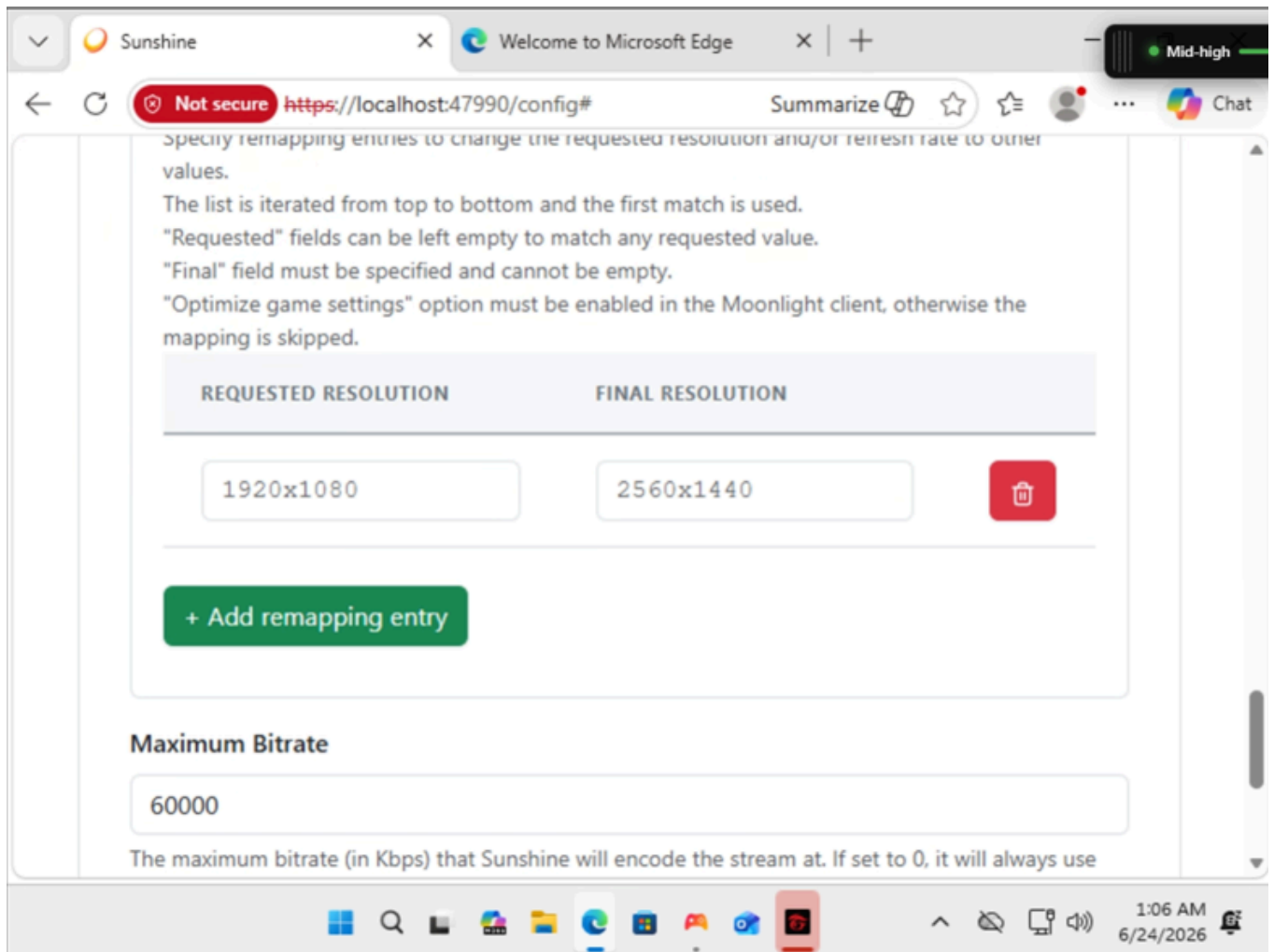
Stream does not scale to requested resolution

Symptom: Wrong size, letterboxing, or stretched picture — the stream does not match the resolution the renter chose in Moonlight.

Fix: Delete the default **Resolution Remapping** rule in Sunshine.

1. On the machine, open `https://localhost:47990` → **Configuration**.
2. Scroll to **Resolution Remapping**.
3. If you see a row like **Requested** `1920x1080` → **Final** `2560x1440`, click the **red trash icon** on that row to delete **both** the requested and final resolution fields (remove the whole row).
4. Leave **no remapping entries** unless you intentionally want to force a different host resolution.
5. Click **Save**, then restart Sunshine from the Controller **Sunshine** page if needed.
6. Start a new test stream and confirm the picture matches the client's requested resolution.

*Remapping only applies when **Optimize game settings** is enabled in the Moonlight client. If scaling still looks wrong after deleting the row, see [virtual display not showing up](#) in the full guide.*



Virtual display not showing up

Try, in order:

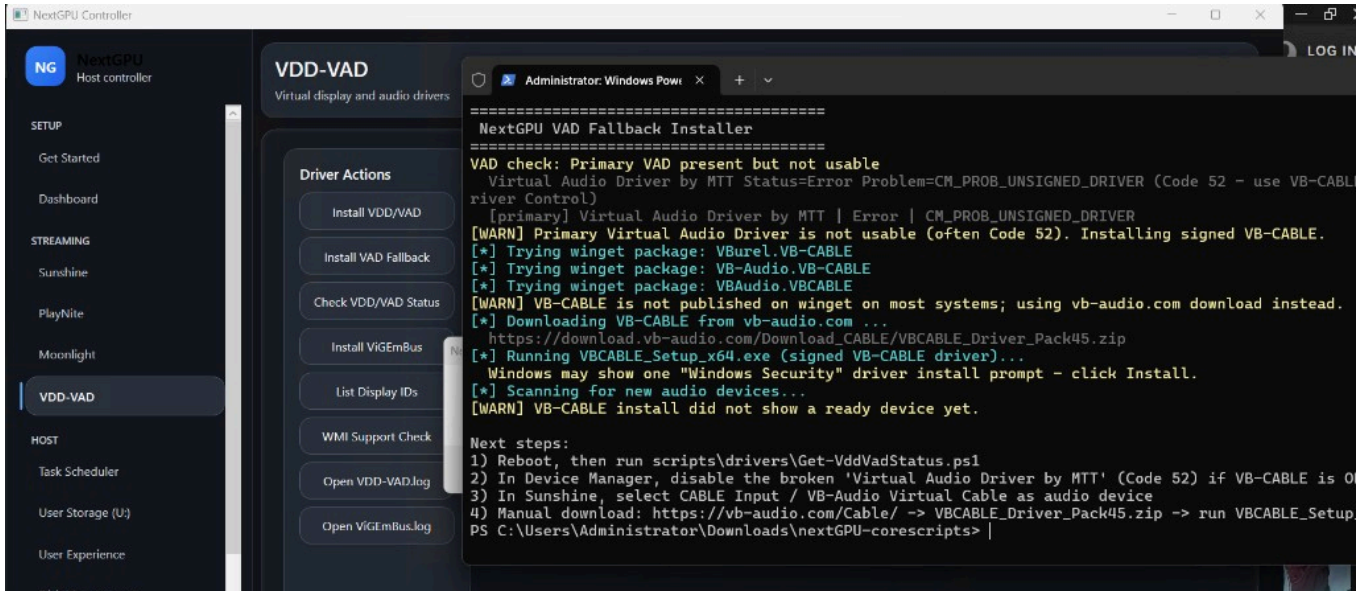
1. Controller → **Install VDD/VAD** (or reinstall from **VDD/VAD** page).
2. Reboot.
3. Point Sunshine at the VDD display — find `device_id` in Sunshine logs (`https://localhost:47990` → **Troubleshooting** → **Logs**), paste into **Configuration** → **Audio/Video** → **Display ID**.

Full walkthrough: [machine-setup-beginner.md#manual-fix-point-sunshine-at-the-vdd-display](https://github.com/Libretto/machine-setup-beginner.md#manual-fix-point-sunshine-at-the-vdd-display)

No audio during a stream

Likely cause: Virtual Audio Driver (VAD) failed or is unsigned (Code 52 on some Windows 11 builds).

1. Controller → **VDD-VAD** → **Install VAD Fallback**.
2. Let the script finish — it may install **VB-CABLE** when the primary VAD is not usable.
3. **Reboot** if the script says the device is not ready yet.
4. In Sunshine (`https://localhost:47990` → **Configuration** → **Audio/Video**), set the audio device to **CABLE Input**.
5. Start a new test stream and check audio.



"rclone install failed" but sync still works

Run `rclone version` in a terminal. If a version prints, ignore the warning.

Desktop wallpaper wrong or icons visible

1. Re-run wallpaper setup.
2. Run **Wallpaper Verification**.
3. Ensure Sunshine was started within the session.

Can't shrink the drive (Step 2)

Run `powercfg /h off`, move page file off `C:`, clear System Restore points on that drive, reboot, retry shrink.

PlayNite imported zero games

Start the **Everything** search tool, let drives index, then re-run import from the **PlayNite** tab.

Renter storage (U:) missing

1. **User Storage** → **Diagnose & fix**.
2. **Mount U: for Moonlight**.
3. If still missing, re-run **One-Click S3 Setup** (Step 5).

Push Moonlight Games to AWS failed

1. Confirm `moonlight-web` service is running.
2. Confirm games show in Moonlight locally.
3. Check `domain.txt` has `COMPUTER_NAME=` and `PUBLIC_IP=`.
4. Re-run **Push Moonlight Games to AWS (Setup Games & Apps → Host Setup** tab).
5. **Restart Sunshine** (Controller → **Sunshine** → **Restart Sunshine**), then push again.

Restart Sunshine

If Sunshine isn't working properly, you can try restarting it. This will terminate any running sessions.

 Restart Sunshine

More help

Topic	Link
Full troubleshooting (all symptoms)	machine-setup-beginner.md#if-something-goes-wrong
Glossary	machine-setup-beginner.md#glossary
Log file locations	machine-setup-beginner.md#key-logs
Technical reference	README.md